

Zeeshan Ilahi

Full-Stack Engineer | MERN & Java/Spring Boot | Microservices

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Full-stack engineer with 2+ years of professional experience building and shipping production applications across MERN and Java/Spring Boot stacks. Track record of owning features end-to-end, from REST API design and database modeling through React/TypeScript UI delivery. Comfortable working across the full request lifecycle, from browser to distributed backend. Authorized to work in the US via OPT, no sponsorship required.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Futurewonder, AI & Software Developer Intern

05/2025 – 12/2025 | Bloomington, Indiana

- Reduced enterprise page load time by ~70% by building a reusable **React/TypeScript component system**, standardizing layouts, and applying image optimization (lazy loading, modern formats, appropriate sizing).
- Implemented an automated code review pipeline using **Cursor AI API, AWS CodePipeline, and Docker**, cutting CI/CD testing time in half and improving deployment reliability across microservices.
- Resolved **120+ engineering tickets**, including 15 production-critical defects, reducing repeat incidents and measurably improving release stability.
- Delivered 10 infrastructure improvements supporting uptime and scale; conducted **40+ code reviews** focused on architecture, modularity, and security best practices.

Meritto, Software Engineer

05/2023 – 08/2024 | India

- Developed and shipped **12+ React/TypeScript UIs** for enterprise clients, owning the full frontend lifecycle from component design through production handoff.
- Improved operational efficiency by ~30% through **backend query optimization, workflow automation**, and elimination of manual steps in recurring client processes.
- Maintained ~98% **client satisfaction** and met 100% of committed delivery deadlines; integrated Stripe and Google Maps APIs with robust error handling and edge-case coverage.
- Recognized with the **Annual Best Performer Award (2023)** and **Time Excellence Award (2024)** for reliability and ownership in client delivery.

Takneeki.inc, Software Developer Intern

01/2022 – 06/2022 | India

- Contributed to **UPI payment integration** for enterprise clients, working across Python, PHP, Java, and Node.js within a single engagement cycle.
- Adopted TDD practices from the ground up, wrote test coverage for all implemented features, and communicated directly with clients during final delivery stages.

PROJECTS

The Game Store , Full-stack e-commerce platform

- Engineered a production-style **MERN application** with a RESTful Express API, MongoDB/Mongoose models, React/Redux frontend, role-based **JWT authentication**, and admin tooling for products, orders, and users; built solo end-to-end.
- Built **Redux Thunk** workflows for catalog, cart, checkout, and order management with search, filtering, and paginated listing; integrated PayPal checkout with inventory reservation on order placement.
- Wrote **Jest unit tests** for critical catalog and order utilities; deployed frontend to Vercel with a clean CI workflow and optimized for **mobile-responsive browsing**.

Patient AI Operations Portal , Java/Spring Boot Microservices Platform

- Architected a **6-service microservices** backend in **Java 21 + Spring Boot** with Spring Cloud Gateway, dedicated **auth service (JWT)**, **gRPC** between Patient and Billing services, and **Apache Kafka** for async event streaming.
- Built an AI service **integrating Google Gemini** with output sanitization, rule-based fallback paths, and structured DTOs for **explainable risk scoring, anomaly detection, and intervention simulation**.
- Containerized with **Docker Compose** and deployed to a DigitalOcean VPS; observability via **Zipkin** distributed tracing.

Phishing Detection System , AI-powered security analysis platform

- Built a Flask-based service that analyzes emails, files (PDF, Word, TXT, EML), and URLs for phishing signals using **Google Gemini API** with automatic model fallback.
- Hardened with rate limiting, input validation, and a GitHub Actions CI pipeline; engineered consistent **risk scores and confidence levels** from LLM responses.

EDUCATION

Luddy School of Informatics, Computing, and Engineering, Indiana University,

08/2024 – 05/2026 | Indianapolis, USA

MS Computer Science (GPA 3.6/4.00)

Coursework: Software Engineering, Database Management Systems, Cloud Computing, Data Structures and Algorithms, Trustworthy Causal Artificial Intelligence, Advanced Operating Systems, Computer Networks, Data Science, and Interaction Design Practices.

Graduate Teaching Assistant: Mentored 80+ students as a TA for Software Systems, debugging, model validation, and guiding full-cycle development of software projects

SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Java, SQL

Technologies: React.js, Redux, Node.js, Express.js, Spring Boot, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, MySQL, REST APIs, JWT, OAuth 2.0, Docker, AWS, GitHub Actions, Jest, pytest

Concepts: Full-Stack Development, Microservices Architecture, API Design, CI/CD, System Design, Test-Driven Development